

Born when Poland was undergoing one of its greatest periods of economic growth, I was perplexed by the stories told by my elders concerning the dawn of communism. As expected from individuals who were politically active in both eras, my house was filled with debates on the fundamental changes brought by the post-1989 socioeconomic and legal transition. Having that opportunity, I grew passionate about politics, the inner workings of legal systems, and economic transformation, particularly in the context of Eastern Europe. The decision to study Social Sciences is thus a purposeful choice to deepen my understanding of the phenomena that shaped my family's past and will shape my future.

Dedicated, already at 15, I moved from my hometown to Krakow to study the IB curriculum, selecting subjects aligned with my long-term goals. At a Higher Level, I chose History to understand the past and its political systems, and Psychology to explore human behaviour—a fundamental driver of history and society. It was during History, particularly while studying the Great Depression of 1929, that I became captivated by the interconnectedness of politics, economics, law, and psychology. It was fascinating how a simple human emotion, fear, could destabilize an entire economy through panic-selling of stocks and loss of confidence in banks. Even further, the response to the crisis ultimately undermined the laissez-faire system in favour of Keynesian economics: the state must play an active role in stimulating the economy. Roosevelt embraced this philosophy through the New Deal, with policies ranging from his Fireside Chats addressing public morale to the Agricultural Adjustment Act, which paid farmers to reduce crop prices. This has shown me that the broader understanding of these interconnected fields, despite being presented as separate disciplines, is what I am academically and passionately chasing.

Besides my passion for humanities, my talent for sports is shown by how, at only 16, I signed my first professional contract, which moved me from my local city club, Korona Kielce, to join one of the best Polish clubs, Cracovia Kraków. Here, I participated in local, regional, national, and international U-17 competitions that ultimately led me to be offered trials with Celtic Glasgow in 2021. Beyond sports, I have been an active member of the student body – in my first year of IB, I founded, organized, and managed the Study Abroad Association, which sought to raise awareness and establish links with foreign institutions to expand opportunities for talented students. In this role, I contacted a British company to deliver webinars at school. Recognizing my proactivity, the company offered me a 6-month internship, my first work experience. These experiences, alongside my time volunteering for Charity Foundation to aid Ukrainian refugees, taught me discipline, resilience, and teamwork—values I will bring to the university.

This program will equip me to contribute meaningfully to society. I plan to grow internationally, address global and local issues, and pursue a career in this field. With

its reputation and inspiring modules, the University of Hong Kong is the perfect place to achieve my goals.

